



UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE INTERNATIONAL EXAMINATIONS
International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/11

Paper 1 Reading Passage (Core)

October/November 2011

READING BOOKLET INSERT

1 hour 45 minutes

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Insert contains the reading passage for use with both questions of the Question Paper.

This document consists of **3** printed pages and **1** blank page.



Read the following passage carefully and then answer all the questions in the Answer Booklet.

The writer, Paul Theroux, is travelling through Asia by train. In this passage he describes his journey to Mumbai in Southern India.

Night Train to Mumbai (The Superfast Express)

The lovely heart of Jaipur is what the tourist sees...

Content removed due to copyright restrictions

...They were getting off at Santa Cruz, while I continued the whole way into the heart of the city.

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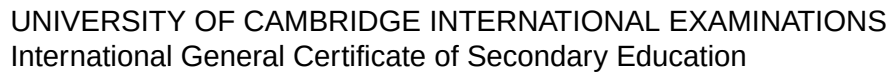
Copyright Acknowledgements:

Reading Passage

© (adapted) Paul Theroux; *Ghost Train to the Eastern Star*; Penguin Books Ltd, 2009.

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0500/11

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1 hour 45 minutes

Additional Materials: Reading Booklet Insert

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name on all the work you hand in.
Write in dark blue or black pen.
Do **not** use staples, paper clips, highlighters, glue or correction fluid.
DO **NOT** WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **6** printed pages, **2** blank pages and **1** Insert.

Question 1

For
Examiner's
Use

Read carefully the passage *Night Train to Mumbai (The Superfast Express)* in the Reading Booklet Insert and then answer all the questions.

- (a) Explain what the writer means by 'But the train traveller sees a different Jaipur' (lines 3–4).

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (b) Which **one** word in the first paragraph tells you that some of the buildings in Sanganer were in a poor condition?

..... [1]

- (c) Explain, **using your own words**:

- (i) why the writer felt that the name 'Superfast' was not suited to the train.

.....

..... [1]

- (ii) why the speed of the train was 'consoling' to the writer (line 15). Give **two** reasons.

-
.....
-
..... [2]

- (d) Why does Mr Gupta think 'Planes are a problem.' (line 21)?

.....

..... [1]

- (e) Give **two** reasons why there are now fewer tigers in this part of India.

-
.....
-
..... [2]

(f) Explain, **using your own words**, what the writer means by:

(i) 'it sprawls to the horizon' (line 5);

.....
..... [2]

(ii) 'peering from the ornate walls' (line 32);

.....
..... [2]

(iii) 'part of the panorama' (line 43).

.....
..... [2]

(g) Re-read lines 34–40. Choose **three** short phrases which the writer uses to describe what he saw from the train window.

Explain how each of these phrases helps to create a picture in your mind of the people and their surroundings.

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....
.....

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....
.....

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....
..... [6]

[Turn over for Question 1(h)]

- [2]

- Write a paragraph of about 50–70 words.

..... [7]

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[Turn over for Question 2]

Imagine you are Paul Theroux, the writer. After you arrive in Mumbai, you spend some days relaxing and catching up on note taking before continuing with your journey.

- your thoughts and feelings about your recent journey and the people you have met
- the reasons why you would want to return and spend more time in the area.

You should base your ideas on what you have read in the passage, but do not copy from it.

You should write between 1 and 1½ sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting.

Up to ten marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to ten marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dashed lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a guide for handwriting practice. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

[illegible]

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.....
[Total: 20]

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